

Joseph Jones / Copywriter

Coins Flash Fiction

We were in communion, one of those special ones where the altar boys run around with fire in little swinging braziers. Not that I'd care if the church burned down. Anyway, my mother-in-law was watching the plate come closer, her hand clutched tightly around a dollar bill. For our small farming community, she always paid the most tithes, and always paper money, while the other offerings were usually quarters and dimes, maybe garden produce. When the plate got to her, she leaned as far from the plate as she could before closing her eyes and dropping the bill onto the heap of change. Odd, but normal for her. Judy had just nudged me awake and I had forgotten to put my quarter on the plate, so I reached over my mother-in-law. I didn't feel Judy's hand on my shoulder until too late. Judy's mother thinks that coins are infected with some horrible disease, and if a thousand dollars in coins, the traitor Judas, and I were in a burning house, she'd save Judas. But when she felt me reaching over her shoulder and saw the coin in my hand, she jumped like a Holy Roller. Her knee hit the plate and coins sprayed everywhere, including her open mouth. I feel I should be thanked for stopping her from choking, and she certainly got closer to God that day than any other sermon she's had to sit through, but I'm banned from church and Judy hasn't spoken to me in two weeks. Tell me how to fix this.

-A Perturbed Husband